

# Uddannelsesvalg efter folkeskole



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Suriname. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great question, and it's awesome that you're already thinking carefully about your future. Since you're 16 and just finished primary school (which typically ends earlier in Denmark — so perhaps you meant **folkeskole**, ending after 9th or 10th grade), you're now at the point of choosing between several educational paths. Here's a breakdown of your options in Denmark, along with guidance based on your background and potential interests:

## Main Educational Paths After Folkeskole (9th/10th grade)

### 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

If you're interested in going to **university** later on, this is the typical route.

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen):** Broad academic focus – good for university.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen):** Business- and economics-oriented – good if you're interested in finance, management, or international business.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen):** Science and technology-oriented – great for engineering, IT, or health science.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen):** Shorter (2 years) and more flexible – often for students who want to continue in health or social fields.

 **Recommended if:** You like school-based learning, enjoy subjects like math, history, languages, science, etc., and are open to studying more after this.

### 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – EUD/EUX)

This is practical education leading to a **skilled trade or profession** (e.g., electrician, hairdresser, carpenter, IT-supporter, healthcare assistant).

- **EUD:** Focused on working right after.
- **EUX:** Combines vocational training with academic studies – you can work **or** continue to university.

 **Recommended if:** You want hands-on experience, learn better by doing, and are thinking of starting to earn earlier. EUX gives you flexibility if you're not 100% sure yet.

## What Should You Consider?

Since you mentioned you're fluent in Danish and were born/raised in Denmark, you have equal access to all educational paths. Being of Surinamese heritage might also offer you unique strengths like multicultural understanding or multilingual skills if you speak Sranan Tongo, Dutch, or other languages at home.

Here are a few questions to reflect on:

- Do you enjoy more academic/theoretical work, or more hands-on, practical work?
- Are there subjects you really enjoy (e.g., science, languages, business, tech)?
- Do you want to work as soon as possible, or are you thinking long-term (e.g., university)?
- Do you like working with people, computers, machines, or ideas?

## Some Example Paths Based on Interests

| Interest                   | Path Recommendation                                        |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| I want to go to university | STX or HHX depending on subject interests                  |
| I want to run a business   | HHX → Business academy or entrepreneurship                 |
| I like tech or IT          | HTX or EUX (IT-supporter → later IT engineer)              |
| I like working with people | HF or EUD in social/healthcare                             |
| I want a job quickly       | EUD with job guarantee (e.g., electrician, mechanic, chef) |

## Bonus Tip – Cultural Identity

As someone with Surinamese roots, you could also explore international options or special programs for multicultural youth. Being bilingual or bicultural can be a **huge asset** in careers like international business, diplomacy, education, or NGOs.

## Final Advice

Take your time to visit [uddannelsesguiden.dk](https://uddannelsesguiden.dk) and talk to a **study counselor (studievejleder)**. Also, **visit open house events** at local schools or programs.

If you tell me more about what you're interested in — subjects you like, your goals (short and long term), or what kind of work you imagine yourself doing — I can give you a more personalized suggestion.